WILEY JOURNALS · USING AI TOOLS IN YOUR RESEARCH

AI Guidelines for Authors

A guide to disclosure, protecting your content and keeping intellectual leadership

Disclose | Verify | Protect your rights

Summarised from the Wiley AI guidelines page · accessed 26 October 2026

AUTHOR PRINCIPLES

Six principles for authors

1. Review the terms

Confirm the tool does not claim ownership of your content or limit its use. Recheck the terms periodically.

2. Human oversight

AI is a companion to writing, not a replacement. You are fully responsible for accuracy, citations and analyses.

3. Disclosure

Record the purpose, any effect on key arguments and how you verified outputs. Disclose at submission.

4. Rights protection

Avoid tools that restrict your, Wiley's or others' use of the material, or gain rights over it, including training rights.

5. Responsible use

Respect privacy law, avoid copying others' styles, fact-check outputs, mitigate bias and use privacy controls for sensitive content.

6. Your agreement

Follow your Wiley author agreement, including the representation that the work is original and unpublished.

> Journals may request your documentation of AI use. The guidance is not legal advice.

PROTECTING YOUR CONTENT

Evaluating an AI tool

Feature	Look for	Be wary of
Ownership and rights	No claim to your content; no limits on your use of it or the outputs	Broad claims such as “perpetual” or “transferable”, “royalty-free”, “for any purpose”
Training and model use	Opt-out of retention and training, or none by default; use limited to the service	Training on your content without consent; outputs labelled “open” or placed under Creative Commons
Storage and sharing	Clear options to delete your data	Indefinite retention; sharing with third parties without clear limits

> Enterprise or institutional versions are generally the safest option for unpublished or sensitive material. Still review their terms and your institution’s guidelines.

PROTECTING YOUR CONTENT

Privacy in research practice

Reviewers and editors

Never upload any part of a submitted manuscript. It is confidential.

Human subjects research

Ask your IRB whether AI use with participant data needs approval, and whether consent forms cover third-party AI services.

Personal or private data

Remove personal identifiers before using non-enterprise tools. Enterprise tools may allow identifiable data if governance, IRB approval and consent permit.

Embargoed data

Follow all sharing restrictions.

Your own drafts and data

Use professional judgement. Work with smaller segments and substitute key details to keep material confidential.

Keep out of public tools

Regulated data (HIPAA, FERPA), private information, confidential or embargoed content, novel findings and unique methods.

INTELLECTUAL LEADERSHIP

You direct, AI assists

Your role

- Define goals and expectations
- Give specific directions
- Evaluate outputs with your domain knowledge
- Seek AI input, but make the changes yourself
- Decide what is included, and disclose

Avoid over-reliance

- Letting AI decide instead of informing your judgement
- Relying on AI summaries instead of primary sources
- Accepting suggestions you do not understand
- Using AI to bypass skill-building

When not to use AI

- You are building core expertise
- Data is sensitive, unpublished or confidential
- Institutional or funder rules restrict use
- Verification would be substantial
- A reliable established method fits better

DISCLOSURE AND DECLARATION

Where to disclose, and what to include

Acknowledgments

Help with drafting, editing, translation or formatting.

Methods

AI in methodology, data collection or analysis, or literature review.

Figure captions

AI-generated or AI-edited visual content.

A disclosure should state

- The tool name and version
- The date or year of use
- The tool's role, and the sections affected
- Your role in directing and reviewing the output
- For sensitive or human-subject data, how privacy was maintained

Agree wording with co-authors early. If you are unsure whether something needs disclosure, err on the side of disclosing.

DISCLOSURE · DRAFTING AND EDITING

Drafting and editing: disclose or not

Disclosure required

Text generation. Generating or substantially rephrasing text, drafting standard sections, turning notes into prose.

Translation. Translating sections such as the abstract or methods.

Organisation. Restructuring arguments or flow, reorganising sections.

Argument and logic. Finding gaps, checking whether results follow from methods.

Tone and audience. Flagging tone, reframing for other readers.

No disclosure needed

Language polishing. Grammar, spelling, word choice, rephrasing awkward sentences.

Conciseness. Cutting words while keeping the meaning.

Formatting. Citation formatting, style adaptation, readability checks.

> Wiley supports purposeful AI use for drafting and editing. You remain fully responsible for accuracy and integrity.

DISCLOSURE · RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Methods: four areas of AI use

Code development

Disclose. Writing analysis scripts or algorithms, custom research software, automated pipelines, developing or adapting models.

No need. Debugging, code style formatting, comments and documentation, recommending standard library functions.

Data and analysis

Disclose. Qualitative coding, statistical analyses, outlier flagging that changes conclusions, test interpretation, exploratory or cross-dataset synthesis.

No need. Routine unit conversion, format standardisation, data entry, deduplication or typo fixes.

Literature review

Disclose. Agentic searching, screening against inclusion criteria, synthesis used in the manuscript, extracting citations.

No need. Keyword search support where you decide inclusion, reference management, citation formatting.

Study design and data collection

Disclose. Generating survey questions, processing images, developing protocols, building databases or platforms.

No need. Organising protocols, troubleshooting software, learning explanations, formatting templates.

DISCLOSURE · VISUALS

Visuals and images

Data visualisations: allowed

Charts, graphs and plots may be made with AI. Disclose and verify accuracy. Specialised visualisation software is preferred over general language models.

Research illustrations: allowed

Conceptual diagrams and flowcharts may be made with AI. Disclose, verify there are no factual errors, and check licensing.

Photographs: not enhanced by AI

AI-edited photographs are not permitted. Minimal uniform edits such as contrast or colour in standard software are acceptable. AI analysis must be disclosed in Methods.

Evidential images: not permitted

Images supporting scientific, clinical or technical claims, such as results, experimental data or diagnostic images, may not be generated, modified or enhanced by AI.

> Caption disclosure names the tool and version, date or year, the tool's role and your role. Original images may be requested at submission.

CONTENT RIGHTS AND PERMISSIONS

Copyright, authorship and AI

Human authorship

AI is not recognised as an author. Tools cannot hold copyright or be accountable for published work.

Own it before publishing

You, your institution or employer must hold the copyright. On acceptance, rights pass to the journal owner by agreement.

Infringement risk

AI may reproduce third-party material, more so when generating than editing. Outcomes range from revision to retraction.

Reduce the risk

Use tools that cite sources and check them. Avoid copyleft outputs. Prefer editing your own work to generating new content.

Check tool licences

Confirm broad reuse with no commercial or distribution limits. Avoid CC BY-SA and CC BY-NC. Include required attribution.

Co-authors

Each must truthfully claim authorship and account for AI help. Discuss AI use and disclosure together.

> Your methods, analysis and conclusions should show that you directed the work and kept intellectual control.

LITERATURE REVIEW AND QUALITY

Keeping references real

Using AI for literature work

- Complement database searches, do not replace them
- Ask for primary sources and check claims against originals
- Read full primary texts for work critical to your project
- Prefer tools that link to sources and show their databases

Verify every citation

- AI can produce fabricated references that look real
- Confirm each is a real publication
- Check the DOI resolves in a database, library catalogue or publisher site
- Check the source makes the argument attributed to it

AI can generate plausible but shallow content. Provide original analysis, support claims with evidence and interpret statistics carefully.

Bias and environmental impact

Six biases, six mitigations

Publication access. Paywalled work is underrepresented: search databases.

Geographic and cultural. Use targeted and international sources.

Stereotyping and language. Watch for biased wording.

Disciplinary and methodological. Consult adjacent fields.

Sustainability. Prompt for environmental impact.

Temporal. Training cutoffs miss recent work: use live databases.

Intensity	Research task examples
Light	Proofreading, grammar checks, formatting references
Moderate	AI-assisted search, short drafts, generating code, summarising short documents
Heavy	Synthesising many papers, long documents or large datasets, research figures
Very heavy	Unsupervised multi-step workflows, video abstracts, 3D models

> Match the tool to the task. Skip extended reasoning for simple edits.

COMPARISON

Wiley and Springer Nature for authors

Topic	Wiley	Springer Nature
Where to declare	Acknowledgments, Methods or figure captions, by type of use	Introduction or Acknowledgements; Methods or equivalent; AI Declaration and caption for visuals
Language polishing	Grammar, spelling and word choice need no disclosure	Grammar and language editing is green: describe the use
Code	AI-written scripts or algorithms: disclose in Methods. Debugging: no	Code scaffolding is green: describe the tool and purpose
Images	AI-edited photographs not permitted. Charts and diagrams allowed with disclosure	Visuals from verifiable inputs allowed with disclosure. Others not permitted

> Where rules differ, Wiley advises following the most restrictive applicable policy, and always your journal’s own instructions.

PRACTICE · OPTIMISATION CASES

Do you need to disclose?

For each case, decide whether disclosure is needed, where it goes, or whether the use is not permitted.

A

An LLM corrects the grammar and spelling in your abstract and rephrases two awkward sentences.

B

An LLM writes the Python code for your conjugate gradient solver and benchmark scripts. You test and revise it.

C

An AI tool turns your results file into a performance-profile plot for the paper.

D

An AI tool sharpens a photograph of your robot test rig before you include it in the paper.

PRACTICE · SUGGESTED ANSWERS

What the Wiley page implies

Case	Answer	Why
A	No disclosure needed	Grammar, spelling, word choice and rephrasing are language polishing. Springer Nature expects green uses to be described, so check the target journal.
B	Disclose in Methods	Writing analysis scripts or algorithms requires disclosure. Name the tool, version, date and role, and say how you tested and revised the code. Debugging alone would not.
C	Disclose in the caption	Data visualisations generated from your data require disclosure. Verify the plot against your result files. Specialised tools are preferred over general language models.
D	Not permitted	AI-edited photographs are not allowed. Minimal uniform contrast or colour correction in standard image software is acceptable.

PRACTICE · AUTHOR CHECKLIST

Before you submit

- ✓ **Terms.** I read each tool's terms. None claims rights over my content or trains on it.
- ✓ **Oversight.** I reviewed all AI output and take responsibility for it.
- ✓ **References.** Each exists, its DOI resolves, and it supports the claim.
- ✓ **Records.** I kept tool, version, date, purpose and how I verified outputs.
- ✓ **Disclosure.** Placed in the Acknowledgments, Methods or captions as the use requires.
- ✓ **Images.** No AI-edited photographs. No evidential images generated or enhanced.
- ✓ **Confidentiality.** No embargoed, identifiable or manuscript-under-review material went into public tools.
- ✓ **Agreements.** Co-authors agree the wording. I checked journal, institution and funder rules.

SOURCES AND SCOPE

Where this guide comes from

Wiley: Using AI tools in your research
wiley.com/publishing/article/ai-guidelines

Springer Nature: AI use in manuscript preparation
springernature.com/.../ai-manuscript-preparation

Springer Nature: AI guidance for researchers, editors, reviewers
group.springernature.com/.../ai-guidance-for-researchers-editors-reviewers

Scope and caveats

> The Wiley page was read on 26 October 2026 through a summarising tool. Wording is paraphrased apart from short quotes.

> Wiley’s separate book authors’ guide, Best Practice Guidelines and the COPE position were not opened.

> The comparison, scenarios and checklist are written for this deck, not publisher text.